

Your Pet's Eye Was Surgically Removed

A guide for your pet's recovery at home

Your pet had a surgical procedure called an enucleation — the removal of one eye — while at the shelter, when the eye could not be saved and would otherwise cause ongoing pain. Refer to your adoption paperwork for specific medications and follow-up instructions.

What to Expect

- Enucleation is the surgical removal of an eye that could not be treated or saved. The eyelids are sutured closed permanently.
- Swelling, bruising, and mild discharge around the site are normal for the first 24–48 hours, improving over the following 1–2 weeks.
- Most pets adapt remarkably well to life with one eye, often with little change in quality of life.

Home Care

- Apply any medication to the surgical site exactly as directed.
- The e-collar must stay on at all times when unsupervised.
- Keep the area dry — no baths, swimming, or getting the site wet.
- Restrict activity — no running, jumping, or rough play until cleared.

Contact Your Veterinarian If Your Pet Has:

- Increasing swelling, redness, or warmth at the site after 48 hours
- Thick, yellow, or foul-smelling discharge, or a suture line that appears to be opening
- Pawing at or rubbing the site despite the e-collar
- Any redness, cloudiness, squinting, or discharge from the remaining eye

Follow-Up Care

Schedule a follow-up visit with your veterinarian within **10–14 days** after surgery, as directed in your discharge paperwork.

If you have any concerns before that visit, do not wait — call your veterinary clinic.